

KEH-KUAN SUN

Department of Economics
Fairfield University
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September 2026

Research Interests

Behavioral/Experimental Economics, Microeconomic Theory, Economics of Networks

Academic Positions

2023 - Present Assistant Professor
Department of Economics, Fairfield University
2021 - 2023 Postdoctoral Research Associate
Smith Institute for Political Economy and Philosophy, Chapman University

Education

May 2021 Washington University in St. Louis, St. Louis, MO, USA
Ph.D., Economics
Dissertation Title: *Essays in Behavioral and Experimental Economics*
May 2019 Washington University in St. Louis, St. Louis, MO, USA
Master of Arts, Economics
Aug 2015 Yonsei University, Seoul, Republic of Korea
Bachelor of Arts, Economics (Minor in Applied Statistics)

Santa Monica College, Santa Monica, CA, USA
Venice High School, Venice, CA, USA
Santa Fe Trail High School, Carbondale, KS, USA

Research

Publication

“Lying Aversion and Vague Communication: An Experimental Study” (with Stella Papadokostas), *European Economic Review*, Volume 160, November 2023, 104611.
DOI: 10.1016/j.euroecorev.2023.104611

“Habits as Adaptations: An Experimental Study” (with Ludmila Matysková, Brian Rogers, and Jakub Steiner), *Games and Economic Behavior*, Volume 122, July 2020, pp. 391-406.
DOI: 10.1016/j.geb.2020.04.013

Working Paper

“Non-Allais Paradox and Context Dependent Risk Attitudes” (with Edward Honda, submitted)

DOI: 10.48550/arXiv.2411.13823

We provide and axiomatize a representation for preferences over lotteries that generalizes the expected utility model. Since the representation uses different utility functions to evaluate different lotteries, the preferences can be interpreted as coming from individuals that have context-dependent attitudes toward risks. The model enables generating various violations of the independence axiom that are not compatible with some of the most prominent models of non-expected utility. Depending on the specification chosen, the model can range from being very flexible with many different utility functions to being parsimonious with few or just one utility function.

“When AI Improves Answers but Slows Knowledge Creation: Matching and Dynamic Knowledge Creation in Digital Public Goods” (submitted)

DOI: 10.48550/arXiv.2604.00468

Generative AI helps users solve problems more efficiently, but without leaving a public trace, shrinking the archives that future problem-solvers depend on. We build a dynamic model of public good provision where agents contribute by solving problems posted on a public platform, and accumulated solutions form a depreciating public archive. AI reduces archive creation through two margins: a flow margin (posted volume declines as AI resolves problems privately) and a resolution margin (conditional resolution declines as AI raises contributors’ outside options, thinning the contributor pool). The two margins interact through a self-undermining feedback that can generate low-archive traps, and the decomposition yields a diagnostic prediction distinguishing supply-side pool thinning from private diversion alone. Encouraging public sharing of AI-assisted solutions offsets private diversion but cannot repair participation-driven deterioration in conditional resolution, which requires maintaining contributor engagement directly.

Work in Progress

“Shaded Truth under Consequential Risk: A Framework for Survey-Based Valuation When Respondents Distrust Delivery”

Stated-preference practitioners frequently observe respondents who state low or zero willingness to pay, citing distrust of policy delivery as their reason. This paper proposes consequential risk, a framework in which such responses are rational: respondents who believe the survey is consequential but perceive implementation failure strategically shade their WTP downward. We separate policy selection from benefit delivery and derive an attenuation identity linking failure beliefs to the valuation object. A joint design pairing a controlled experiment with a field survey shows that the distribution of failure beliefs is nonparametrically identified via multiplicative deconvolution, with partial identification results when the key conditional independence assumption is relaxed. The framework yields an empirically implementable decomposition of stated valuations into full-delivery value and perceived failure beliefs.

“Pandering after Failure: Outcome Bias and Policy Reversal”

Evaluators often overweight realized outcomes when judging decision quality, which in political accountability settings can generate pressure for inefficient policy reversal. This paper

studies a benchmark channel: after a public failure under policy A, some voters overweight the failure's informational content via a power-likelihood rule, increasing electoral pressure for a switch to B. A challenger who privately believes continuation with A is more likely correct may nonetheless promise B to improve election prospects, and when promises are binding or reversal is irreversible, this produces inefficient reversal. The main result characterizes the challenger's unique optimal platform choice and provides an explicit cutoff for when the challenger promises reversal despite a posterior favoring continuation. Extensions endogenize the pre-failure history, relax commitment and lock-in, and add competence types to connect to selection and reputational incentives.

"The Framing Effect of Numerical Denomination on Measured Risk Preferences" (with Edward Honda)

We design and implement a laboratory experiment to test whether the numerical denomination in which lottery payoffs are expressed (e.g., dollars vs. points with fixed conversion rates) affects measured risk attitudes within standard elicitation methods. Interdisciplinary evidence and patterns of independence-axiom violations à la Allais suggest that numerical representation may influence choice under uncertainty. Our within-subject design spans four widely used tasks and systematically varies denomination type and conversion complexity. We test whether risk-preference estimates remain invariant within a given method, whether denomination affects cross-method consistency, and whether large or unfamiliar denominations increase choice anomalies such as preference reversals and random switching in probability-choice menus.

"Reporting Incentives and the Structure of a Community"

Individuals of a given moral disposition may act differently depending on the pattern of connections in a community. This paper examines how the network structure of a community affects a witness and her reporting incentive through a model of favor exchange over a social network. A key factor that affects the reporting decision of a witness to a crime in this model is the relative impact of the offender on the witness's local network. The result identifies what kind of society is more susceptible to hidden crime. It gives a warning especially for a closed community for the potential harm of overly intertwined mutual neighbors.

Conference and Seminar Presentations

2027	ASSA 2027 Annual Meeting, Washington, DC (scheduled)
2026	2026 North American ESA Conference, Charlottesville, VA (scheduled) 2026 Midwest Econometrics Group Annual Meeting, Cincinnati, OH (scheduled) Behavioral and Experimental Economists of the Mid-Atlantic (BEEMA10), University Park, PA 37th Stony Brook International Conference on Game Theory, Stony Brook, NY 2026 ESA World Meetings, Los Angeles, CA 2026 ESIF Economics and AI+ML Meeting, Ithaca, NY 2026 North American Summer Meeting, Atlanta, GA 2026 Behavioral Models of Politics Conference, Durham, NC Midwest Theory Spring 2026, Columbus, OH Washington University in St. Louis, St. Louis, MO Chapman University, Orange, CA Korea Institute for International Economic Policy, Sejong, Korea Korea Development Institute, Sejong, Korea
2025	Ninth Annual Meeting of the PPE Society, New Orleans, LA
2024	North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society, Nashville, TN 99th Annual Conference of Western Economic Association International, Seattle, WA Fairfield University, Fairfield, CT
2023	Meeting of the Behavioral and Experimental Economists of the Mid-Atlantic, New York, NY Hitotsubashi University, Tokyo, Japan Asia-Pacific Economic Science Association Conference, Seoul, Korea Midwest Economics Association Conference, Cleveland, OH Fairfield University, Fairfield, CT
2022	North-American Economic Science Association Conference, Santa Barbara, CA Missouri Valley Economic Association Annual Meeting, St. Louis, MO Washington University in St. Louis, St. Louis, MO AEA 2022 Annual Meeting (Poster)
2021	ESA Global Online Around-the-Clock Meetings Asian Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society ECONtribute Summer Workshop 2021 on Social Image and Moral Behavior Tokyo Institute of Technology Berlin School of Economics Korea Information Society Development Institute
2020	The Economic Science Association Job-Market Candidates Seminar Series 9th Annual Conference of the American Society of Health Economists (cancelled) Midwest Economics Association Conference (cancelled)
2019	Econometric Society Summer School, Sapporo, Japan Midwest Economics Association Conference, St. Louis, MO

2018 Economics Graduate Student Conference, Washington University in St. Louis
 ISET Seminar, Washington University in St. Louis
 7th Annual Conference of the American Society of Health Economists, Atlanta, GA

Teaching Experience

Fairfield University

Introduction to Microeconomics (Undergraduate)	2023-2026
Introduction to Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)	2024-2025
Behavioral Economics (Undergraduate)	2023-2024
Honors Mini-Seminar (Undergraduate)	2025-2026

Chapman University

Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate)	2021-2022
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Washington University in St. Louis

Introduction to Microeconomics (Undergraduate)	Summer 2017
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Laboratory Experience

Lab Manager - Washington University in St. Louis

Missouri Social Science Experimental Laboratory (Supervisor: Brian Rogers)	2016-2020
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Honors, Awards, and Fellowships

Summer Research Stipends, Fairfield University	2024
McDonnell International Scholar (Mirae Asset Corporate Fellowship), McDonnell International Scholars Academy, Washington University in St. Louis	2015 - 2020
Teaching and Research Assistantship, School of Economics, Yonsei University	2012-2015
Full Tuition Scholarship, Hyundai Asan Foundation	2012-2013
One Asia Foundation Scholarship, One Asia Foundation	2012
Chair of Asia Economic Community Foundation Award, Asia Economic Community Foundation	2012
Leadership Service Scholarship, Yonsei University	2011
Full Tuition Scholarship, Yonsei University	2010-2011

Professional Services

Referee

Journal of Economic Psychology, Humanities and Social Sciences Communications, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Frontiers in Education, Frontiers in Global Women's Health

Member

American Economic Association, the Econometric Society, Economic Science Association, Korea-America Economic Association, Midwest Economic Association

Administrative

Search Committee for full time faculty hire, Department of Economics, Fairfield University	2024-2025
Organizer, Economics Department Seminar Series, Fairfield University	2024-present
Diversity, Equity & Inclusion Committee, Dolan School of Business, Fairfield University	2024
Student Life Committee, Fairfield University	2024-present
Research Committee, Dolan School of Business, Fairfield University	2024
Organizer, Microeconomic Theory Workshop for Graduate Students, Washington University	2018 - 2019
Organizing Committee, 13th Economics Graduate Students Conference, Washington University	2018
Organizing Committee, 12th Economics Graduate Students Conference, Washington University	2017
Organizer, Graduate Student Association Breakfast Seminar, Washington University	2017 - 2019
Leadership Service, Graduate Student Association, Washington University	2017 - 2021
Volunteer, North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society	2017

Skills

Languages: Korean (native), English (fluent), Japanese (fluent), Chinese (intermediate)
Programming Languages: R, Python, PHP, JavaScript
Experiment Software: zTree, oTree
Lab Management: ORSEE, Linux server and git repo management

References

Brian Rogers (Chair) Department of Economics Washington University in St. Louis St. Louis, MO 63130 ☎ +1-314-935-8924 ✉ brogers@wustl.edu	John Nachbar Department of Economics Washington University in St. Louis St. Louis, MO 63130 ☎ +1-314-935-5612 ✉ nachbar@wustl.edu	Jonathan Weinstein Department of Economics Washington University in St. Louis St. Louis, MO 63130 ☎ +1-314-935-4942 ✉ j.weinstein@wustl.edu
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